

# SHASHANK REDDYHALLI RAKESH

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AI/ML Engineer, published researcher, and 0→1 founder with 5+ yrs in tech, turning research into production ML, leading communities 100,000+ strong. 1st place & 6th worldwide, SmashHack.

## EDUCATION

|                                                             |                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| University of California San Diego                          | 2025 – Present |
| Master of Science in Data Science                           |                |
| Visvesvaraya Technological University                       | 2021 – 2025    |
| Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science and Engineering |                |

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (3+ years)

|                                                                                                           |                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| UC San Diego — Student Assistant (Operations)                                                             | Mar 2026 – Present                                      |
| • Beyond administrative support, automate manual workflows into internal tools that save staff hours.     |                                                         |
| Digitide — Data Scientist Intern                                                                          | Feb 2025 – Jun 2025                                     |
| • Powered business decisions by building end-to-end ML pipelines (EDA, features, NLP) over 100k+ records. |                                                         |
| • Reached a 0.98 F1 score in production by shipping tuned predictive & time-series forecasting models.    |                                                         |
| UAS Dharwad — Product Manager, AgriTech                                                                   | Mar 2025 – Aug 2025                                     |
| • Owned product strategy & built a university-backed AgriTech marketplace for startups to onboard & sell. |                                                         |
| Blueed — Research & Development Intern                                                                    | Jul 2024 – Nov 2024                                     |
| • Powered product decisions for 2,000+ active users by building WaitKyu's data & analytics backbone.      |                                                         |
| • Lifted UX by shipping ML-powered insights and rigorously tested, reliable features.                     |                                                         |
| Orbitor (Bharat Intern) — Data Science & ML Intern                                                        | Jan 2024 – Mar 2024                                     |
| • Developed predictive ML models for survival analysis & classification, reaching ~92% accuracy.          |                                                         |
| • Lifted model performance through rigorous feature engineering, EDA & pipeline optimization.             |                                                         |
| VOIS — AI/ML Intern Oct-Nov'23                                                                            | EdVedha — Full Stack Web Developer Intern Nov'23-May'24 |
| IBM -Cyber Security Intern Oct-Nov'23                                                                     | UniConverge Technologies-SDE Intern & Mentor May-Aug'23 |

## PROJECTS & PUBLICATIONS

|                                                                                                     |              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| AudioVeritas – Deepfake Audio Detection System                                                      | IJRASET66025 |
| • Engineered an SVM deepfake-audio detector on MFCC/spectral features, 95.7% accuracy.              |              |
| • Published and secured funding to advance the work in media forensics & cybersecurity.             |              |
| Deep Learning Approach for Early Colorectal Cancer Detection using Speech Biomarkers                | IJRASET63556 |
| • Built a CNN for early colorectal cancer detection from vocal biomarkers (non-invasive, low-cost). |              |
| • Optimized model performance for reliable recognition in real-world applications.                  |              |
| Hierarchical Deep Learning for Robust Intrusion Detection in Evolving Security Landscape            | IJRASET58300 |
| • Designed a hybrid DL+ML intrusion-detection system with an adversarial-example detector.          |              |
| • Achieved accuracy gains under adversarial conditions with optimized use of compute.               |              |
| Security Issues and Defensive Approaches in Deep Learning Frameworks                                | IJRASET57752 |
| • Mapped attacks to defenses across deep-learning frameworks in a practical threat-model taxonomy.  |              |
| • Delivered a blueprint for trustworthy, secure AI in production deployments.                       |              |
| Certifying Text Classifiers vs Levenshtein Attacks – Reproducing LipsLev (ICLR 2025)                | Medium       |

## COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP & ENTREPRENEURSHIP (reaching 100,000+ globally)

|                                                               |                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| TechForge Club - Founder & President Oct'23-Jul'25            | FOSS United - Chapter Lead & Organizer Sep'23-Aug'25 |
| ParrotSec (HTB) - India Lead & Global Moderator Mar'20-Jun'25 | Cybernity - Co-Founder, intl. May'20-May'25          |

## SKILLS & ACHIEVEMENTS

**Technical Skills:** Python, SQL, R, C++, Java, JavaScript; PyTorch, TensorFlow, Scikit-learn, XGBoost, Transformers, NLP; LLMs, RAG, Hugging Face, LangChain, LoRA/PEFT; AWS, GCP, Docker, Git, MongoDB, PostgreSQL

**Awards:** 1st place & 6th globally, [SmashHack ML Hackathon](#) (UC San Diego & NSF HDR); *Outstanding Achievement & Contribution Award* (JNNCE); *Runner-up, Hack for Hire* (Anvesana TBI)

**Certifications:** [Data Science for Engineers](#) (NPTEL), [Python Course](#) (Google - Coursera), [Ethical Hacking](#) (zSecurity)